larynx. It goes up during breathing to allow the air to enter into the trachea and it moves down during the swallowing of food and drinking fluids to allow the food to enter the oesophagus.

Oesophagus

The oesophagus is a long straight hollow structure that starts at the pharynx and ends at the stomach. The upper portion of the oesophagus has skeletal muscles and the lower portion has smooth muscles. Oesophagus has a sphincter at the top of pharynx end and it has a sphincter at the bottom of the stomach which prevent food from flowing back into the pharynx from oesophagus and backing up from the stomach into the oesophagus. The primary role of the oesophagus is peristalsis, wave like movements that move and propel food and fluids along the digestive tract with the help of muscles.

Stomach

The stomach is a hollow organ on the left side of the abdomen that collects and processes food and fluids. The stomach has the fundus, body and antrum. The stomach secretes digestive enzymes, such as pepsin, hydrochloric acid and gastric acid to facilitate the digestive process. As the food and fluids are processed in the stomach, a partially digested chyme is formed. Pepsin digests proteins; and hydrochloric acid provides the pH of acidity that is necessary for digestion. Minimal absorption of water soluble vitamins and some medications such as aspirin takes places at stomach.

Liver

The liver is an abdominal organ and gland on the right side of the abdominal cavity and near the center of the body. The liver produces bile which is then transported to the gallbladder through the common bile duct and then to the small intestine. Bile is used for the breakdown and digestion of fats.

Small Intestine

The chyme from the stomach is mostly absorbed in the small intestine as usable minerals and nutrients. The small intestine also receives bile and the pancreatic enzymes from the bile ducts. These pancreatic enzymes break down carbohydrates, fats and proteins for absorption. The small intestine is also a hollow abdominal tube that connects to the stomach at its upper end and to the large intestine at its lower end which sphincter prevents back flow.

The three parts of the small intestine are the duodenum, jejunum and ileum

Iron is absorbed in the duodenum, jejunum absorbs all of the products of digestion and the ileum absorbs any remaining nutrients that has left behind.

Large Intestine

The large intestine is involved in the absorption of water and the removal of by products of digestion through defecation. The two major parts of the large intestine are the cecum and sigmoid colon.

The caecum is connected to the appendix which has an unknown role and the colon absorbs water and propels waste to the rectum.

Rectum

The rectum is a part of the lower gastro intestinal tract. It is a continuation of a sigmoid colon and connects to the anus. The key role of the rectum is to act as a storehouse for feces.

Anus

The anus is the last part of the digestive tract. The lining of the upper anus is specialized to detect rectal contents. It knows whether the contents are liquid, gas or solid.

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